

The past simple

CG Languages · grammar sheet

When to use it

For a finished action at a finished time in the past. The time is often said, or clear from the context.

*I **visited** London last year. She **called** me yesterday.*

Regular verbs: add -ed

Verb ends in...	Rule	Example
most verbs	+ ed	work → worked
-e	+ d	live → lived
consonant + y	y → ied	study → studied
short vowel + consonant	double it + ed	stop → stopped

Saying -ed: three sounds

Sound	After	Examples
/t/	p, k, s, sh, ch, f	stopped, worked, watched
/d/	voiced sounds and vowels	lived, played, called
/ɪd/ — an extra syllable	t and d only	wanted, needed, visited

Only after **t** or **d** does -ed add a syllable. *Worked* is one syllable, not “work-ed”.

Questions and negatives: did

Use **did** and the **base form**. The past is shown once, by *did*, never twice.

	Example
Question	Did you watch the film?
Negative	I didn't watch it.
Not	Did you watched...? I didn't watched.

Irregular verbs

Many common verbs do not use -ed: *go* → *went*, *see* → *saw*, *buy* → *bought*. Learn them with the **Irregular verbs** deck in the app.